Mermaid · both fence characters

A tilde fence draws its diagram

CommonMark fences with backticks **or** tildes, and Markdown treats the two as the same thing. The live preview always did. The export did not — until this deck.

What was wrong, and where

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

The CLI substituted an SVG for a backtick fence and nothing else, so a tilde fence printed as **raw source** in the PDF.

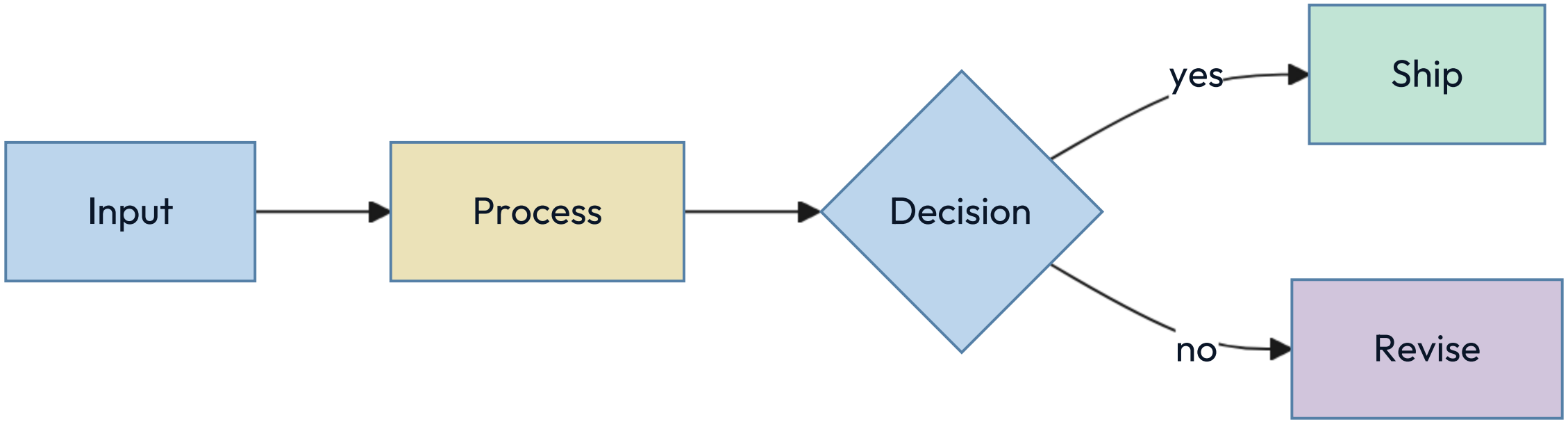
The author could not see it coming: the preview they wrote in renders both. The next two slides are one diagram, written two ways.

KEY INSIGHT

markdown-it emits `class="language-mermaid"` for either fence, and the runtime keys on that class.

A backtick fence.

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

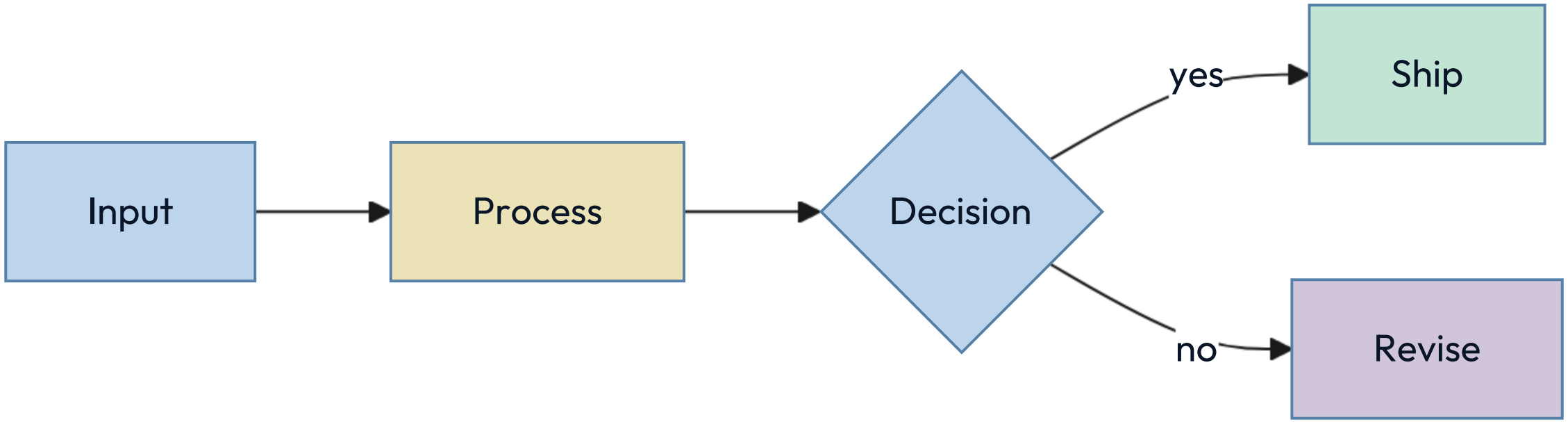


KEY INSIGHT

The form every deck in this repo already uses.

A tilde fence.

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS



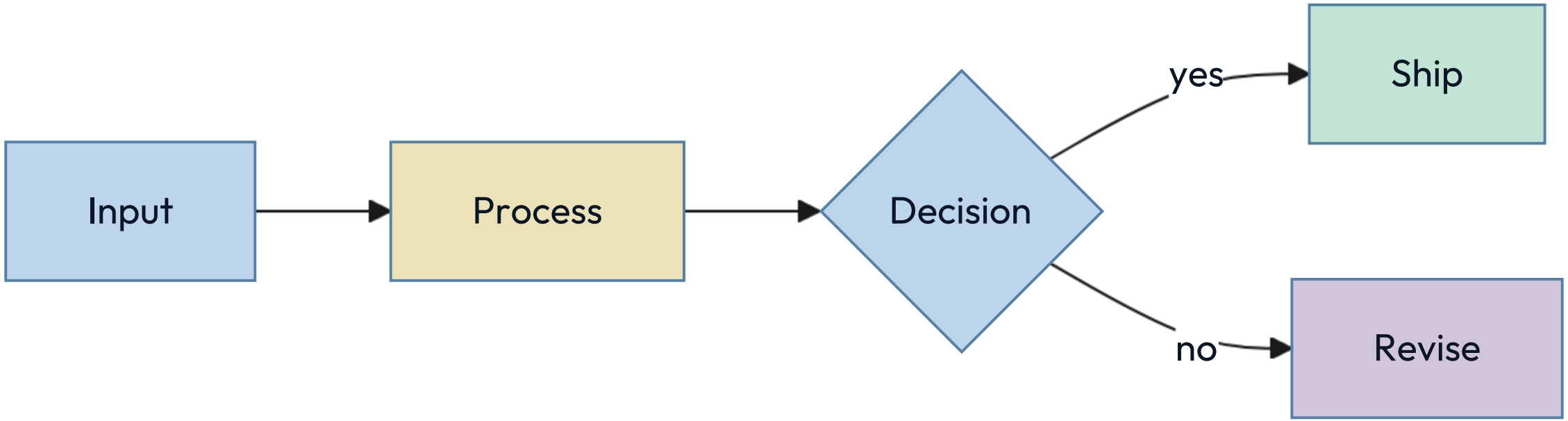
KEY INSIGHT

Identical bytes on the slide. Before this change, this page printed five lines of Mermaid source.

A fence indented under a bullet.

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

The flow this deck is about:



Checked against what the engine draws

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

Three spaces of indent is still a fence, so a diagram under a bullet draws. Four is a code block. A closer may outrun its opener. A fence inside a fence is a sample. A commented-out fence is not a fence.

KEY INSIGHT

Every one was a real export bug. The worst: an indented **closer** never closed, so one substitution ate two slide separators and a three-slide deck exported as a single page.

One walker, and what it is allowed to move.

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

Both callers read it

The CLI's substitution, and the narrator. Widen one alone and the voice cannot read the diagram.

It walks lines, not a regex

A closer may outrun its opener; a fence inside a fence is a sample. A regex got both wrong.

No deck's bytes moved

Measured across every tracked file: three docs changed, each already substituting its own example.